



English — Cbse English — Combined Half-Yearly (40 Marks)

Subject: English | Class: Class 8

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The paper has four sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Section D assesses the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 1 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Plastic We Cannot See When we think of plastic pollution, we picture bottles choking rivers or bags drifting in the sea. Yet, an even more insidious threat often escapes our eyes: microplastics. These are tiny plastic fragments, smaller than five millimetres, that silently infiltrate our soil, water, and eventually our food. Microplastics enter the environment in several unnoticed ways. Synthetic clothing sheds microscopic fibres during every wash, which flow into drains. Personal care products, like face scrubs, once contained microbeads that slipped through water-treatment plants. In agriculture, plastic mulch used to retain soil moisture breaks down over time, leaving behind particles that mix with the earth. Plants absorb these particles, and when animals graze or humans consume these crops, microplastics quietly enter our food chain. The health implications of this invisible invasion are concerning. While scientists are still studying the long-term effects, evidence suggests that microplastics can carry harmful chemicals and may accumulate in human tissues. This is not merely an environmental issue; it is a direct sustainability and health challenge that demands immediate action. Fortunately, everyday choices can significantly reduce this hidden menace. Washing synthetic clothes less frequently, using natural fibre garments like cotton, and avoiding single-use plastics can cut down the shedding of microplastics. Supporting bans on microbeads and choosing products with minimal plastic packaging further limits the flow of these particles into ecosystems. In conclusion, the battle against plastic pollution is not just about cleaning up visible waste. It requires awareness of the plastic we cannot see. By making mindful, sustainable choices today, we can protect both our environment and our health for future generations. (i) What is the central idea of the passage? [1 mark(s)] (A) Microplastics are a hidden but serious threat that requires mindful everyday choices to control. (B) Plastic bottles and bags are the main causes of river and ocean pollution. (C) Scientists have already found a complete cure for the health effects of microplastics. (D) Agriculture is the only source of microplastic pollution in the food chain. (ii) According to the passage, how do microplastics enter agricultural soil? [1 mark(s)] (A) Through the breakdown of plastic mulch used for soil moisture. (B) Through microscopic fibres from synthetic clothing. (C) Through microbeads from personal care products. (D) Through chemical fertilizers sprayed on crops.	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(iii) What can be inferred about the current state of scientific knowledge regarding microplastics? [1 mark(s)] (A) Scientists have completely mapped the health effects of microplastics. (B) Scientists have proven that microplastics only affect animals, not humans. (C) Scientists are still investigating the long-term health effects of microplastics. (D) Scientists are certain that microplastics do not affect human tissues. (iv) Which word from the passage means 'gradually and secretly causing harm'? [1 mark(s)] (A) Infiltrate (B) Insidious (C) Accumulate (D) Shedding (v) Which everyday choice directly reduces the shedding of microplastics into water systems? [1 mark(s)] (A) Using more plastic mulch in farming. (B) Buying personal care products with microbeads. (C) Avoiding natural fibre garments like cotton. (D) Washing synthetic clothes less frequently. (vi) According to the passage, what are two ways microplastics enter the environment? [1 mark(s)] (vii) Why does the author call microplastic pollution an 'invisible invasion'? [1 mark(s)] (viii) Why is choosing products with minimal plastic packaging recommended? [1 mark(s)] (ix) How do everyday choices help in reducing microplastics? Explain with two examples from the passage. [2 mark(s)]	
Section B — Writing Attempt 1 out of 1.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	Story Writing Write a story based on the following cues: • Arjun has just moved to a new town and feels lonely. • A sudden storm forces him to take shelter at an old bus stop. • He meets an elderly stranger there, and something unexpected happens. Give your story a suitable title. (Word limit: 95–145 words) <i>(Word limit: 95–145 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Paragraph Write a descriptive paragraph (80–100 words) on A Rainy Day that you remember fondly. You may use the following cues: • When and where it happened (e.g., school trip, holiday, sudden shower). • Sensory details — what you saw, heard, smelled, and felt. • What you and others did during or after the rain. • A concluding line on why the day stays in your memory. <i>(Word limit: 70–105 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 5 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
3	Unless you submit the assignment by Friday, the teacher ___ marks. [Conditionals] (A) will deduct (B) deducts (C) would deduct (D) had deducted	1
4	A new bridge ___ being constructed across the river to connect the two villages. [Gap Filling] (A) is (B) are (C) was (D) has	1
5	The jury ___ unable to agree on a verdict after three days of deliberation. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) was (B) is (C) were (D) has	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
6	The teacher praised Ravi and ___ for the excellent science project. [Direct & Indirect Objects] (A) I (B) he (C) me (D) she	1
7	If he ___ the school captain, he would introduce a longer lunch break for everyone. [Conditionals] (A) was (B) is (C) will be (D) were	1
Section D — Literature Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
8	What does Bibha Chowdhuri's nomination by Erwin Schrödinger tell us about her abilities? <i>[Ch 15: Bibha Chowdhuri: The Beam of Light that Lit the Path for Women in Indian Science]</i>	2
9	Do you think the cherry tree would survive? Why do you think so? <i>[Ch 10: The Cherry Tree]</i>	2
10	Irony is a literary device that emphasises the difference between what is expected and what actually happens. It often involves a situation where the outcome is the opposite of what is expected, creating a surprising or a humorous effect. For example, Mrs. Jones' excitement about her garden contrasts with the speaker's disappointment on how ordinary it is. Identify the line(s) from the poem that display(s) situational irony. <i>[Ch 2: A Concrete Example]</i>	2
11	What is the difference between a fact and an opinion? Explain with examples. <i>[Ch 7: The Case of the Fifth Word]</i>	2
12	How can we say that the grandmother shared her husband's dedication to a greater cause? <i>[Ch 6: Verghese Kurien—I Too Had A Dream]</i>	2
13	What does the crew's action of passing the oxygen bottle around 'like a pipe of peace' suggest about their response to the situation? <i>[Ch 13: Feathered Friend]</i>	2
14	How was the boy's approach towards the old woman different from that of the other boys in the group? <i>[Ch 5: Somebody's Mother]</i>	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
15	Have you ever waited for the rains? Why? <i>[Ch 12: Waiting for the Rain]</i>	2
16	Intonation is the rise and fall of the pitch of tone while speaking. The 'falling' tone is the fall in the pitch of the voice from a high level to a low level. It is marked [→]. The falling tone is generally used in imperative sentences. Read the following sentences from the text with the falling tone. <i>[Ch 8: The Magic Brush of Dreams]</i>	2
17	What might be the writer's purpose of highlighting the awe-inspiring natural wonders of India? <i>[Ch 9: Spectacular Wonders]</i>	2

